

Taylor Simpson

Product Designer | taylor.daniel.simpson@gmail.com | Toronto, ON

Portfolio: taylorsimpson.ca | linkedin.com/in/td-simpson

SUMMARY

Product Designer with 6+ years spanning the full product lifecycle, from research and strategy to design, launch, and iteration. With a background in software development, product management, and UX writing, I bring a technical and strategic perspective that ties design decisions to user needs, business goals, and measurable growth.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Product Designer (Contract)

Feb. 2026 – Present

SettleKit

Remote

A personalized guidance platform that helps new immigrants to the USA set up their life with content tailored to their visa, goals, and progress.

- Design flows that use progressive disclosure to break high-stakes processes into stages, keeping users oriented across journeys that can span months
- Designed the commercial provider experience, allowing users to set preferences and compare options within SettleKit's own interface, reducing drop-off at key third-party handoff points
- Lead UX writing throughout the product, in plain accessible language suited to non-native English speakers
- Restructured how we write about each topic, shifting from checklists that tell users what to do to guides that explain the context first, increasing topic completion and cutting production time from weeks to days
- Prototype concepts in Claude Code to test ideas with engineers and stakeholders before committing to specs
- Grew the platform from a limited MVP to hundreds of active users, with expanded topic coverage and partnerships with banks and financial providers

Product Designer

Aug. 2024 – Apr. 2026

Social Good Fund

Remote

A 501(c)(3) fiscal sponsor. I worked on one of their initiatives – an iOS/Android app connecting people and organizations seeking help with those offering their time, skills, or donations.

- Led independent user research, sourcing leads through AI tools and cold email and interviewing 25 Portland-based nonprofit organizations to uncover their workflows and pain points
- Synthesized findings into feature requests and validation criteria that directly shaped the product roadmap
- Delivered comprehensive UX specs including user flows, wireframes, and copy that address core use cases, edge cases, and usability pain points, cutting concept-to-launch time by 40%
- Collaborated with engineers by implementing UX and copy fixes directly in the codebase, freeing them for higher-priority development and reducing overall implementation time by 20%
- Owned in-app copy and contributed to marketing content; developed team-wide guidelines that standardized voice and tone, improving consistency and content production speed across the team

Product Manager

Sept. 2020 – Aug. 2023

Lexir

Remote

A B2B distribution and e-commerce SaaS platform enabling craft wine and spirit brands to enter the European market through importation, warehousing, e-commerce integrations, last-mile delivery, and local sales partner connections.

- Led the development and release of Lexir's brand dashboard and storefronts, owning the product roadmap and go-to-market strategy, working with a design and engineering team of 5
- Shaped the dashboard's information architecture and flows, defining how brands managed products, stock, pricing, and payouts across multiple markets
- Led regular client interviews that drove new dashboard features improving adoption and retention — for example, brands unsure how to set prices for a new market led me to build a self-serve margin calculator
- Drove a shift from custom builds to no-code tools, cutting development costs 60% and shipping faster

- Created and managed marketing campaigns across email, social media, ads, blogs, events, SEO, influencer marketing, and community outreach
- Grew the client base from a handful of brands to 70+ and scaled the platform from 1 market to 8 in Europe

Content Strategist

Apr. 2018 – Mar. 2019

QHacks

Kingston, Ontario

- Developed and implemented marketing strategies for the biggest university event post-orientation week, attracting 1200+ applicants and \$100k+ in sponsorships
- Led all external communications, writing and editing copy across the website, dashboard, handbooks, emails, and ads, and created the brand's first content style guide used by a team of 20 (and still used today)

Software Developer

May 2018 – Dec. 2018

Orange Gate Consulting

Toronto, Ontario

- Spearheaded a new department developing Android-based applications for consumer robots, leading Orange Gate to shift its core business focus toward robot applications
- Designed wireframes, user flows, and prototypes presented in person to C-Suite client executives for BMO and General Motors at client sites in Toronto and Detroit

EDUCATION & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Queen's University

2015 – 2019

Bachelor of Computing, Computer Science, Specialization in Software Design

Kingston, ON

- Teaching Assistant: Artificial Intelligence (CISC 352)
- Marketing Commissioner: Computing Students' Association

Smith School of Business at Queen's University

2016 – 2020

Certificate in Business

Kingston, ON

BrainStation Toronto

2023 – 2024

UX Design Certificate

Toronto, ON

SKILLS

- **Design & Research:** Figma, Adobe Illustrator, Wireframing, Prototyping, User Flows, Journey Mapping, Information Architecture, Interaction Design, UX Writing, User Research, Usability Testing, A/B Testing
- **Product & Strategy:** Agile Development, Product Roadmapping, Go-to-Market Strategy, Data Analysis, Digital Marketing, Marketing Analytics
- **Technical:** Python, HTML/CSS, JavaScript, React.js, Node.js, Java, SQL, Git, Jira, Linear, Confluence
- **AI Tools:** Figma Make, V0, Claude Design, Claude Code, Cursor

ADDITIONAL INFO

- **Awards:**
 - o People's Choice in Human-Computer Interaction – Queen's Creative Computing Showcase (2018)
 - o Top 4 Hack – Hack the 6ix (2017)
- **Fun Achievements:**
 - o Game Show Winner – Splatalot
 - o Silver Medalist – Canada East Short Track Speed Skating Championship
 - o Guinness World Record – Largest Rubik's Cube Mosaic